JOHN KAPANTZAKIS

Senior Software Engineer

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Senior Software Engineer with 12+ years building data-intensive web products across React, Next.js, Node.js, and Ruby on Rails. Currently developing AI-assisted observability features and frontend performance improvements at Netdata Cloud, with prior work shipping merchant, search, and e-commerce products.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Engineer, **Netdata** Feb 2023 – Present

Open-source, real-time observability platform. Frontend of Netdata Cloud, a large, data-intensive React application.

- Developed AI assistant frontend capabilities for Netdata Cloud, including persistent LLM conversations, Netdata-specific tools, and investigation workflows, plus Model Context Protocol (MCP) frontend support.
- Improved React performance by reducing unnecessary remounts and data-processing overhead.
- Reduced frontend CI runtime by about 60% through Jest test sharding and test-reliability fixes.
- Built and evolved the Dynamic Configurations UI for dynamically generated forms, and contributed to AI Insights reports plus enterprise identity features including SCIM, SSO, role and room mappings, and label-driven room membership.

Senior Frontend Engineer, **Adzuna** Feb 2022 – Jan 2023

Job search engine used by 15M+ jobseekers a month across 20 countries.

- Built Labour Market Intelligence, a new data product, from zero to launch in under a year on Next.js, working in a team of three.
- Implemented interactive charts and maps with Apache ECharts, search, grouping, and filtering so users could explore hiring demand, salaries, and trends across multiple countries.

Software Engineer, **Skroutz** Jun 2020 – Jan 2022

One of Greece's leading e-commerce marketplaces. Partners department: tooling for merchants.

- Developed and maintained the merchant platform for orders, payments, and daily operations using Ruby on Rails, Hotwire Turbo, and React.
- Contributed two features to Hotwire Turbo that shipped in Turbo 7 and were credited in the release announcement, and published two engineering articles on progressive data loading in React and lazy loading with Hotwire.

Full Stack Developer, **EpsilonNet** Sep 2014 – May 2020

Greek business-software company. Epsilon ESS, an employee self-service web platform on ASP.NET and C#.

- Progressed from junior web designer to full-stack developer responsible for the product frontend, implementing features end to end across C# backend and TypeScript frontend.
- Introduced TypeScript, webpack, Redux-managed asynchronous views, and unit tests with Mocha, Chai, and xUnit, then built a Node.js and Handlebars CLI to generate form boilerplate across UI, state, and data models.

PROJECTS

hoohooli.gr, Headless e-commerce storefront Dec 2025 – Present

Family business: a live Greek e-shop for handmade baby and toddler clothes. A WordPress/WooCommerce monolith split into a Next.js storefront and a headless WooCommerce backend.

- Moved the product catalogue to a Next.js 16 App Router storefront on Vercel. Kept checkout, payments and accounts on WordPress behind an API subdomain, restyled to match the new UI.
- Carried the cart across both apps through a server-side proxy to the CoCart API, with a cart-key handoff to WooCommerce checkout.
- Cut product API payloads from ~2.4 MB to ~400 KB so they fit the Next.js data cache. Added indexable category routes, a live sitemap and Product/Breadcrumb structured data.

OPEN SOURCE & COMMUNITY

Hotwire Turbo, Open-source contributor 2021

Two pull requests shipped in Turbo 7, credited by name in the release announcement.

PR #327 · PR #367 · Turbo 7 announcement

SKG JS, Thessaloniki JavaScript Meetup, Co-organiser Apr 2025 – Present

Organising meetups and talks for the JavaScript community in Thessaloniki. Speaker: "What's new in React 19", SKG JS Meetup #3, Apr 2025.

skgjs.gr · Talk

Stack Overflow, 11,600+ reputation

stackoverflow.com/users/1221792/kapantzak

SELECTED WRITING

When to Use NoSQL vs SQL: The Ultimate Guide for Choosing a Database — Scalable Path, 2021

TypeScript or Flow: Which Is Better? — Scalable Path, 2020

JS illustrated: The event loop — Medium, 2019

JS illustrated: Promises — Medium, 2019

Hotwire @ Skroutz: Lazy load data with minimum effort — Skroutz Engineering, 2021

Automating boilerplate code generation with Node.js and Handlebars — DEV Community, 2020

Using Redux in a legacy ASP.NET Web Forms project — DEV Community, 2019

SKILLS

Languages	JavaScript, TypeScript, C#, Ruby, HTML, CSS
Frontend	React, Next.js, Redux, Hotwire Turbo, webpack
Backend	Node.js, ASP.NET / ASP.NET Core, Ruby on Rails, SQL Server, WordPress / WooCommerce (headless)
Testing & delivery	Jest, Testing Library, RSpec, Mocha, xUnit, CI pipelines, Git
AI	Claude Code and other AI coding agents, custom skills, CLAUDE.md / AGENTS.md project instructions

EDUCATION

MSc in Applied Informatics, University of Macedonia 2015 – 2018

MSc in Informatics and Management, Aristotle University of Thessaloniki 2008 – 2010

BSc in Economic Science, Aristotle University of Thessaloniki 2001 – 2006